@thedevspaceio

CSS Selectors Cheatsheet

Basic selectors

Selector	Meaning	Example
`*`	Universal selector	`* { ... }`
`E`	Type selector`	`p { ... }`
`.class`	Class selector	`.btn { ... }`
`#id`	ID selector	`#nav { ... }`
`[attr]`	Attribute presence	`a[target] { ... }`

Combinators

Selector	Relationship	Example
`A B`	Descendant. `B` inside `A`	`article p { ... }`
`A > B`	Direct child	`ul > li { ... }`
`A + B`	Adjacent sibling. `B` immediately after `A`	`h2 + p { ... }`
`A ~ B`	General sibling. `B` after `A`	`h2 ~ p { ... }`

Attribute selectors

Selector	Meaning	Example
`[attr]`	Has attribute	`img[alt] { ... }`
`[attr=value]`	Exact match	`a[rel="external"] { ... }`
`[attr~=value]`	Word contains	`[class~="lead"] { ... }`
`[attr^=value]`	Starts with	`a[href^="https"] { ... }`
`[attr$=value]`	Ends with	`img[src$=".svg"] { ... }`
`[attr*=value]`	Contains substring	`[data-id*="post-"] { ... }`

Pseudo-classes (state and structural)

Selector	Meaning	Example
`:hover`	On hover	`button:hover { ... }`
`:focus`	Element has focus	`input:focus { ... }`
`:active`	Activated by user	`a:active { ... }`
`:first-child`	First child of parent	`li:first-child { ... }`
`:last-child`	Last child of parent	`li:last-child { ... }`
`:nth-child(n)`	Select by index (1-based)	`tr:nth-child(odd) { ... }`
`:nth-of-type(n)`	Index among type	`p:nth-of-type(2) { ... }`
`:not(selector)`	Negation	`:not(.muted) { ... }`
`:disabled`, `:checked`	Form states	`input:checked + label { ... }`

Pseudo-elements

Selector	Meaning	Example
`::before`	Insert content before element	`.btn::before { ... }`
`::after`	Insert content after element	`.note::after { ... }`
`::first-letter`	First letter styling	`p::first-letter { ... }`
`::first-line`	First line styling	`p::first-line { ... }`
`::selection`	Selected text	`::selection { ... }`

Grouping & shorthand

Selector	Meaning
`A, B`	Group selectors. Apply same rules to both
`E:not(:first-child)`	Combine structural and negation

Selector functions

Common functional pseudo-classes and selector helpers.

Function	Meaning / notes
`:not(X)`	Select elements that do NOT match `X`.
`:is(X)`	Matches if element matches any selector in list `X`.
`:where(X)`	Like `:is()` but with zero specificity.
`:has(X)`	Parent selector: matches an element if it contains a descendant matching `X`.
`:matches()`	Legacy alias for `:is()`. Prefer `:is()`.
`:nth-child(an+b)`	Structural numeric selector. Supports formulas like `2n`, `odd`, `even`, etc.
`:nth-last-child(an+b)`	Like `:nth-child()` but counting from the end.
`:nth-of-type(an+b)`	Index among siblings of the same element type.
`:nth-last-of-type(an+b)`	Like `:nth-of-type()` counting from the end.
`:lang(language)`	Matches elements with the given language (matches `lang` attribute).